Caught Between Love and Danger: The Day I Accidentally Uncovered My Husband’s Mafia Empire!!

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Caught Between Love and Danger: The Day I Accidentally Uncovered My Husband's Mafia Empire!!

by Lunaeryi

Summary

Phainon thought he knew everything about his husband, Mydei—until he didn't. Between mysterious injuries, strange encounters, and one too many close calls, Phainon's starting to realize there's more to Mydei than meets the eye. But, hey, as long as no one gets hurt…

(Or: Five times Phainon almost figured out Mydei's secret, and one time he did.)

Notes

I already had an outline and draft for this that was at like 2-3k? I wanted 4k so I was just gonna write a bit more, but then it just spiraled from there and I added 5k more than I intended.

Can u believe it? My library didn't allow phones today for some reason so you best believe I squat down angrily (Jk I hid in the corner in fear) and wrote this patiently (Another lie I rushed so no one saw me) because NO ONE tells me what to do😣😣

I'm trying to write 5-10k almost everyday so uh, I hope you guys like long fics😭

I need these 2 to have more fics y'all I keep reloading their tag as if magically more fics are gonna appear

See the end of the work for more notes

The door clicked shut behind Mydei as he walked into the apartment, the familiar calm of home greeting him like an old friend. Phainon was lounging on the couch, a book in hand and his legs kicked up in that lazy, confident way he always did when he was completely at ease. The smell of whatever Phainon had cooked for dinner—probably some random food experiment—drifted from the kitchen.

Mydei tossed his jacket over a chair and kicked off his shoes with a grunt, stretching his arms above his head.

“Back from your ‘important business’ already?” Phainon called out, not even bothering to look up from his book.

“Yep. Finished early,” Mydei replied, walking into the kitchen to grab a glass of water. He leaned against the counter, trying to look casual. “Some of us are *efficient* .”

Phainon’s smirk was practically audible. “Uh-huh. ‘Efficient.’ That what you’re calling it these days? I’ll bet you were just too busy making top-secret calls to finish your ‘business’ today.”

Mydei raised an eyebrow, taking a sip of water. “Well, maybe I was on the phone with some very important people. Ever heard of international espionage?”

Phainon finally looked up from his book, eyes glinting with mischief. “Espionage? You, a secret agent? I can barely get you to do the laundry on time.”

“I do *plenty* of laundry,” Mydei protested, though the look in his eyes told Phainon everything he needed to know.

“Oh, sure, you’re practically a domestic god.” Phainon leaned back with an exaggerated sigh, clearly enjoying himself. “I’m just amazed you can balance saving the world and still make it home for dinner.”

“Someone’s gotta keep this place running,” Mydei said, settling on the armrest of the couch next to him. He shot Phainon a sly grin. “And it’s not like you’re exactly the ‘domestic partner of the year’ yourself. How many failed cooking attempts are we up to now?”

Phainon rolled his eyes, throwing his book to the side and giving Mydei an amused look. “Oh, I don’t know, maybe the same number as your ‘business meetings’ that involve nothing but cryptic phone calls and vague threats.”

Mydei smirked, leaning in like he was about to share a huge secret. “I can’t *confirm* or *deny* the threatening part, but the rest? Definitely a big deal .”

“Right,” Phainon said, his tone dripping with sarcasm. “A real ‘big deal.’ You’re probably the president of a small country or something, aren’t you? Making world-changing decisions in between ordering take-out.”

“Well, if I were the president,” Mydei said, indulging Phainon’s teasing with a smirk of his own, “I’d probably need someone like you to keep the snacks stocked. Gotta have those essentials, y’know?”

Phainon laughed, clearly enjoying himself. “Oh, I know. *World domination* starts with the snacks, after all.”

“Exactly,” Mydei agreed with a chuckle, settling back and glancing at him. “You’d be amazed at how much power those chips hold.”

Phainon shot him a teasing look. “Well, if they’re as important as you say, I guess you do have some secrets after all.”

Mydei just grinned, keeping his cool. “Only the kind worth keeping.”

Mydei’s life was a carefully crafted illusion—a balancing act between the high-powered world of organized crime and the quiet, mundane existence he’d built with Phainon. On the surface, Mydei was nothing more than a business professional, a man of mystery who might have a questionable sense of humor and a penchant for dark sarcasm. Beneath that, though, was a different story—one of global criminal operations, vast illegal empires, and connections to the most notorious syndicates across the globe.

He had it all: the money, the power, the influence—yet you wouldn't know it if you spent an evening with him. His empire spanned multiple countries, controlling strategic trade routes, and he was a key player in global criminal networks, but none of that ever reached Phainon. As far as Phainon was concerned, Mydei was just a man with an interesting job, filled with mysterious phone calls and vague "business meetings" that Mydei always played off as nothing more than casual work.

Phainon had no idea. And that's exactly how Mydei intended to keep it. He had no illusions about what would happen if Phainon found out the truth—his husband would probably throw him out the window or worse, disown him entirely. There was no way Phainon could ever accept what Mydei did. And that's a risk Mydei wasn't willing to take.

So, he did what he had to do: played the part of a calm, teasing partner, hiding his sharp edges and cutting words under layers of affection and light-hearted banter. He could let the world think he was just a guy with connections, running a vaguely mysterious business, as long as Phainon remained in the dark.

And Phainon, in all his teasing glory, had no idea what kind of danger Mydei was really in—or what kind of danger he was *keeping* him from.

The sound of running water from the shower was the only thing breaking the silence in the apartment. Phainon had taken to lounging on the couch, flipping through an old magazine he found tucked between the cushions. He wasn't really interested in the articles, but it was something to pass the time while Mydei took his long, usually cold showers.

Phainon had long since gotten used to the strange, elusive nature of his husband's "business." They never talked about it directly, but Mydei often made mysterious phone calls, dealt with shady acquaintances, and was perpetually vague about everything. But it wasn't like Phainon didn't know how to handle it. He let Mydei do his thing, and it was never really a problem—until it started interfering with their routine.

When Mydei's phone buzzed on the counter, Phainon's first instinct was to ignore it. But the ringing kept going, insistent, until Phainon glanced at the screen. The name on it wasn't a name he recognized, and after a beat, he got up, moved to the counter, and picked it up. Mydei was still in the shower, and the phone wasn't exactly going to stop on its own.

He pressed the green button, holding it to his ear with a casual, "Hello?"

The voice on the other end was deep, gravelly, and with an undertone of authority. "Mydei?" the voice asked, a note of expectation in its tone. "This is Luca. Any updates on the shipment? We need confirmation on the new routes—there's been some disruption in the northern sector."

Phainon's eyebrow arched instinctively. *Shipment? Routes?* That was a bit unusual, even for one of Mydei's "business associates." He could barely understand half of what Mydei did for a living, but shipments and trade routes sounded more like something out of a spy movie. Maybe Mydei had *really* gotten into some shady stuff lately—maybe it wasn't just shipping logistics like he always said.

But Phainon, always one to keep his curiosity in check when it wasn't his business, just nodded as if Luca could see him. "Right, yeah, I'll let him know," Phainon replied, his voice smooth and calm, though internally he was wondering how much of this Mydei was hiding. *Shipping routes, disruptions? That was a little too specific to be just a boring office job.*

Luca's voice was colder now, a hint of impatience creeping in. "Tell him to get back to me soon. We can't afford more delays, especially with the northern passage. The others are getting… restless."

"Got it," Phainon said, the words slipping out easily. "I'll pass it along. We'll make sure everything's good on our end."

There was a brief pause before Luca spoke again, his voice tight. "Good. And make sure there's no more *unexpected* interference. We're not asking for much, just some order ."

“Sure, sure,” Phainon said breezily. He had no idea what the hell any of that meant, but he’d learned a long time ago that keeping things simple usually worked in these situations. “We’ll keep it all in check.”

The line went quiet, and Phainon exhaled through his nose, glancing at the phone before hanging up. He couldn’t help but wonder what Mydei was really involved in. The conversation had sounded like some high-stakes, under-the-radar stuff, but Phainon was used to *that* —vagueness, secrecy— it was practically Mydei’s signature. Still, it didn’t feel right.

But then again, when had anything *ever* felt right about Mydei’s work?

Phainon shook his head, dropping the phone back on the counter. He wasn’t going to stress about it. Maybe it was just business. Mydei’s business. No need to ask too many questions. He had his own things to worry about— like figuring out what to cook for dinner tonight.

Still, something about the conversation lingered in the back of his mind. He ignored it, grabbed the TV remote, and flipped through channels. It wasn’t worth thinking about, right?

When Mydei finally came out of the shower, Phainon gave him a glance. “Hey, you’ve got a call back to make. Some guy named Luca—he’s, uh, waiting on some shipment update. He mentioned something about the northern routes? Sounded important.”

Mydei’s gaze flickered over to him, though his expression remained unreadable. “Luca, huh?” he said, his tone guarded. “Right. I’ll deal with it.”

“Cool,” Phainon replied with a shrug, sinking further into the couch. “Whatever that was about. Just wanted to make sure you knew. I’ll leave you to it.”

Mydei didn’t answer, his focus already shifting to his phone. Phainon couldn’t help but watch him for a moment, a thought creeping into his mind. *What the hell was going on with those routes?*

But he quickly brushed it off, distracted by the flicker of something on the TV. “You know,” Phainon said, trying to make light of it, “I think it’s funny you’re always so busy with this ‘business,’ and yet you never seem to do anything… *actually important.* ”

Mydei didn’t even look up, but Phainon caught a small, almost imperceptible smirk. “You’d be surprised,” Mydei said, voice low and a little too sharp for comfort.

Phainon just nodded, not pressing further. Whatever it was, it wasn’t his problem.

Mydei stood at the counter, staring blankly at the phone after Phainon had left. Outwardly, he looked completely unfazed, like the conversation had been no more important than an email update. But inside, his thoughts were a hurricane.

How the hell did Phainon not catch on?

His jaw tightened slightly, the only outward sign of the irritation bubbling up. The words Luca had said about shipments, routes, *disruptions* —it was all a little too specific. A little too much like something out of his world. Phainon had answered the phone without a second thought, and then *just let it go* .

It was like the universe had thrown him a curveball, and Phainon had effortlessly dodged it, completely unaware of the deadly game Mydei was playing.

Thank fucking god he didn’t figure it out, Mydei thought, running a hand over his face, the tension seeping out slowly. He couldn’t afford to have Phainon asking questions. Not now. Not ever. The last thing Mydei needed was for Phainon to get curious and dig into what he really did. He was too innocent for that. Too good.

But still— *one more slip-up, and I’m fucked.*

He exhaled through his nose, mentally shaking himself. Stay calm. He's fine. Don't overthink it.

One moment of weakness was all it would take to destroy everything.

A quiet buzz from the phone on the counter snapped him out of his thoughts. It was Luca. Mydei didn't even blink. He picked up the phone with deliberate slowness, his fingers brushing the screen like he was about to turn off an alarm.

"Luca," Mydei said, his voice low and smooth, no hint of annoyance, just a cold, measured calm that could freeze the air around him. The way he spoke was deliberate. Like he'd learned a thousand ways to say nothing and everything at once. "You have your answer. I'm handling it."

There was a pause on the other end, then Luca's voice, tight but trying to maintain authority. "You said that earlier, Mydei. I don't need you *handling* it. I need *results*. The northern passage is more critical than you're letting on. You can't afford to fuck this up. I won't tolerate any more *delays*."

Mydei's lips curled into the slightest smirk. He leaned against the counter, a lazy calm washing over him despite the intensity of the situation. "You're not in a position to give me orders. I don't respond to threats. If you want results, *make it happen on your end.* I'm not your errand boy."

There was a shift in Luca's tone, a barely perceptible tightening. He had the sense to realize who he was speaking to. "You're playing a dangerous game, Mydei. If this blows up in your face—"

Mydei cut him off, his voice dropping even lower, turning into something like the hiss of steel being drawn from a sheath. "No one threatens me. You'll do your part. I'll do mine. If you step out of line again, I won't just handle *the route.* I'll handle you. And you'll never see it coming."

The silence on the other end was heavy, suffocating. Luca wasn't stupid. He knew the unspoken threat wasn't just a warning—it was a guarantee. Mydei wasn't the kind of man who had to yell to be understood. His words cut

through the air like a blade, and with every syllable, Luca knew exactly where he stood. One wrong move, and he would be reduced to nothing.

Luca cleared his throat, his voice less confident now. “Understood. I’ll be in touch.”

“See that you are,” Mydei replied, hanging up the phone without a second thought. The line went dead, but the tension still hung in the air like a storm cloud.

Mydei’s hand lingered on the phone for a moment longer than necessary. A slow exhale escaped his lips as he let the weight of the conversation settle. He wasn’t angry— he never was . His calm demeanor was just as deadly as any outburst. But dealing with Luca reminded him how close he was to the edge, and how much he had to keep from Phainon.

With a final glance at the phone, Mydei pocketed it and turned toward the living room. Phainon was still lounging on the couch, oblivious, the sound of him humming quietly under his breath as he flipped through the channels.

Mydei’s expression softened—just a little. The chaos of his world could wait. Right now, all that mattered was keeping up the act. Keeping Phainon safe, away from all the real dangers.

He moved back into the room without a word, slipping into his usual composure, his face carefully neutral again. But inside, a voice whispered, *One more slip-up, and you’ll lose it all.*

Phainon was in the middle of making some half-assed attempt at dinner when the doorbell rang, followed by the sound of a knock that was far too insistent. He cursed under his breath, wiping his hands on a dish towel before tossing it onto the counter.

Another one of Mydei’s ‘business partners,’ he thought, or maybe someone just dropping off something for him again.

He didn’t mind. He was used to it by now—the parade of people who came and went while Mydei was “busy.” Most of the time, Phainon didn’t even ask questions. If it wasn’t worth mentioning, then it wasn’t worth his attention.

With a sigh, he walked to the door and opened it, half-expecting another person in a suit or some other work-wear.

Instead, standing on the doorstep was a tall man, sharp-eyed, well-dressed, with a demeanor that screamed confidence and danger. Phainon couldn’t place him at first, but the guy’s intense look made something tickle at the back of his mind.

“Can I help you?” Phainon asked, his tone casual, though his gaze wandered briefly to the man’s hand that lingered near his jacket, a motion that could’ve been too deliberate for comfort.

The man’s lips curled up in a smile that didn’t quite reach his eyes, and he raised an eyebrow, almost amused. “I was looking for Mydei,” he said, his voice low and smooth, almost too polite. “Is he home?”

Phainon blinked, giving the guy an easygoing shrug. “Nah, not right now. But I’m sure he’ll be back in a bit. You need something? I could probably help you out.”

The man hesitated for a moment, sizing Phainon up. Then, with a brief nod, he stepped forward. “I’m sure you can. I’m an associate of his. I’m sure he wouldn’t mind if I waited a little while.”

Phainon didn’t give it a second thought. *Business partner. Colleague.* Whatever. He stepped back to let the man inside. “Come on in. Mydei’s out at the moment, but I can grab him a message or something. You want a drink while you wait?”

“No, thank you,” the man replied smoothly, stepping in as if he belonged there. He looked around the apartment briefly, his eyes scanning everything with a precision Phainon didn’t notice. He was too busy wondering if he

should order take-out because whatever the hell he was making was about to burn.

“I’ll just wait,” the man added, standing in the living room with his hands tucked into his pockets.

“Sure thing,” Phainon said, crossing over to the kitchen. “Can’t say I’ve got anything that’ll impress you, but it’s dinner time, so…” He trailed off, shrugging, pulling out some random ingredients to salvage his half-assed cooking effort.

A few minutes passed in silence, Phainon focused on salvaging what he could from the mess he’d made of the meal. Meanwhile, the man seemed to grow impatient but said nothing, only watching Phainon from his spot near the couch. Something about the way he stood so still—it didn’t sit right, but Phainon didn’t care enough to ask. Mydei was the one who worried about that kind of thing.

It wasn’t until much later, when the sound of Mydei’s boots thudded at the door, that Phainon finally looked up and saw the brief flicker of relief in the man’s eyes.

Mydei didn’t even look at Phainon when he walked in. He simply crossed the room toward the stranger with a sharp, unreadable look in his eyes.

“Didn’t know you were bringing company today,” Phainon said with a lazy smile, giving Mydei a quick glance as he set the ruined dinner on the table. “But you’ve got a friend here. Came by looking for you.”

Mydei’s eyes flicked to the man with a barely-there nod, the kind of silent acknowledgment that said, *We’ll talk later* . Then, with a small, dismissive glance at the man, Mydei dropped his coat on the back of the chair and moved toward the kitchen, as if nothing had happened.

Phainon was already too distracted by the fact that he’d burned dinner to notice how tense the atmosphere was now. He simply nodded and said, “Well, whatever. I’ll clean up later.”

Phainon had left to grab some more ingredients, still oblivious to the storm brewing in the next room. Mydei watched him go with a quiet, knowing look, then turned back to face the man who'd come to see him.

The air in the room shifted immediately. The relaxed, light atmosphere that had been there when Phainon was around vanished, replaced by something darker, more suffocating. Mydei stood still for a moment, arms crossed, eyes scanning the man like a predator sizing up prey.

The man stiffened, shifting on his feet, his smile faltering as Mydei's gaze bored into him. For a second, he looked like he was going to speak, but Mydei didn't give him the chance.

"You've got some nerve," Mydei said, his voice low, but the edge was undeniable. He spoke slowly, like someone savoring every word, each syllable deliberate. "Coming into my home uninvited… showing up here, thinking you can just walk in and sit like you've got every right to be here."

The man swallowed, his fingers twitching near the inside of his jacket. The tension was palpable, thick enough to suffocate anyone who wasn't used to it.

"I—I didn't know, alright?" the man stammered, but his voice lacked conviction. He was clearly rattled now, the cool front cracking. "I didn't mean to—"

"*You didn't mean to?*" Mydei interrupted, his voice suddenly sharp. He was calm, but the calm was worse than any shouting. "That's the thing about mistakes like yours. They get people killed. You think you can just pop in, make threats like you're still relevant, and walk out unscathed?"

The man's hand hovered near his coat again, like he was considering drawing a weapon, but the sharp, steely look in Mydei's eyes made him pause. Mydei's gaze never wavered, his posture so still it was almost predatory.

"You're getting on my nerves," Mydei continued, his voice dropping lower, quieter, as if the words were laced with venom. "But you've got one chance

to walk away from this, *just one* . Start talking, and keep it brief. Make one wrong move, and I'll make sure you regret it. Understand?"

The man's throat worked as he swallowed, clearly weighing his options. His confidence was almost gone now, replaced by fear.

"Look, I don't know what you're into, alright? I just thought… I thought we were past all this," the man muttered, trying to find some footing in the conversation. "This isn't—this isn't how we handle business, Mydei."

Mydei took a step closer, his tone still unhurried, almost bored. "Business? You think this is business? You think I care about your little disputes? No, no… this is about respect. And you crossed a line when you thought you could come to my house and start playing games. I'm not a fool, and neither are you."

The man took a small step back, his gaze darting to the door, his entire body screaming that he wanted to run. Mydei could see it, could feel it. And he didn't care. In fact, it made the whole situation that much more satisfying.

"I'll make this simple for you," Mydei said, his voice quieter now, and there was a chilling calmness to it that made the man freeze. "You walk out of here, no strange business, and I'll forget this ever happened. But if you so much as *breathe wrong,* I'll make sure you won't get the chance to screw up again. And trust me, you won't *like* how that happens."

The man swallowed again, eyes flicking to Mydei's face, and for a second, he looked like he was about to crack. Mydei waited, making no move, just watching.

The man was already sweating, his body language screaming indecision. But Mydei didn't care. It didn't matter how he reacted, how he spoke. Mydei was in control, and he always would be. He leaned in just slightly, eyes narrowing.

"Now," Mydei murmured, his voice barely above a whisper. "You're gonna walk out of here, and you're gonna forget you ever saw me. Understand?"

The man nodded quickly, then turned on his heel, not daring to speak another word as he exited, practically running for the door.

Mydei watched him leave, his expression never changing, his posture relaxed, almost lazy. But inside? Inside he was already calculating the risks, the moves he needed to make to cover his tracks. The last thing he needed was for anyone to get too curious about what had just happened.

The moment the door clicked shut, Mydei let out a slow breath, and for just a split second, the calm mask slipped, replaced by a sharp glint of irritation. *That was too damn close.*

He glanced toward the exit door, able to picture Phainon in the grocery store, carefully debating which sauce to buy. *Thank God that idiot doesn't know. Thank God.*

Mydei's eyes narrowed slightly as he turned to make a call. He had work to do. And anyone who thought they could mess with his life, his world, was about to learn just how *carefully* he controlled everything.

Eventually, Phainon burst back through the door, bags of groceries in hand, his usual carefree energy filling the room. "I'm back!" he announced with a grin, kicking the door shut behind him. His eyes scanned the room, landing on Mydei with a hint of curiosity. "Hey, where'd the other guy go? Did he leave already?"

Mydei shrugged nonchalantly, his expression unreadable. "Guess so. I wasn't really paying attention."

The air in the room was thick with the heat of the moment. Phainon's breath came out in desperate little gasps, his body arching up against Mydei as pleasure coursed through him. His fingers dug into Mydei's back, scratching viciously as if grounding himself, trying to cling to something real in the overwhelming haze.

“You—fuck, Mydei…” Phainon moaned, eyes half-lidded, his head tilted back as he took in another sharp breath. His body moved with a mind of its own, desperate for more, his hips thrusting up as Mydei’s pace quickened. “Is that… is that all you got?” he teased breathlessly, the words barely making sense through the pleasure.

Mydei’s lips curled into a mocking smirk, his hands braced on either side of Phainon’s waist, holding him in place. “You think you can handle more?” he shot back with a low, amused chuckle. “You’re not exactly in a position to be making demands right now.”

Phainon’s only response was to arch his back again, moaning louder, the teasing banter forgotten for a moment as the intensity grew. Mydei’s hand slipped down, gripping Phainon’s thigh to hold him still, each movement calculated and deliberate, almost cruel in how slow he made Phainon work for it.

When Phainon’s breath hitched once more, his hand lazily traced over a scar on Mydei’s shoulder, a jagged line that didn’t quite match the others. It was a new one. His fingers lingered, unsure, a soft frown forming on his face despite the heat of the moment.

“Mydei…” Phainon murmured, his voice quieter now, concern creeping in. His thumb traced the scar again, his expression shifting. “Where did this come from?”

Mydei’s hand paused, his body stilling for a brief moment. The casual tension in his face remained, but something deeper, something guarded flashed in his eyes. He shrugged, but it didn’t come across as dismissive. “Doesn’t matter. It’s nothing.”

Phainon sat up slightly, his fingers still grazing over the scar, unwilling to let it go so easily. “Doesn’t matter?” He repeated, his voice serious now, a note of genuine concern slipping in. “It’s new. I’ve never seen it before. Where did you get it, Mydei? What happened?”

Mydei’s jaw tightened, and he leaned in closer, his hand gently brushing Phainon’s away from his shoulder. “It’s nothing I can’t handle,” he

muttered, his tone colder now, the mask of indifference back in place. “Don’t worry about it.”

But Phainon didn’t buy it. He studied Mydei’s face for a moment, trying to get past the stone wall he always put up, and for once, Mydei didn’t hide the fact that he was uncomfortable with the question.

Phainon exhaled softly, his thumb brushing across Mydei’s lips. He didn’t push further, but the concern lingered in his gaze. “You don’t have to lie to me, you know,” he said, his voice quieter, tender. He leaned in close, pressing a soft kiss to Mydei’s palm, a silent reassurance.

Mydei didn’t say anything, but Phainon could feel the moment shift, the guardedness that had settled back in. He didn’t push it, though. Not yet. Instead, as if on instinct, Phainon trailed his lips down to Mydei’s neck, the softest of kisses landing on the scar, a silent expression of his worry.

He stayed there for a moment, lips hovering over the scar, unwilling to break the contact. No words were needed now. His concern, his care—it was all there in that one gentle act.

Mydei’s breathing hitched briefly, but he said nothing, his body still and quiet beneath Phainon’s touch. Phainon’s lips stayed pressed against the scar for a few more beats before he finally pulled away, his gaze lingering on Mydei’s face. Mydei didn’t look at him, but Phainon could feel the subtle tension, the shift.

“Let’s just… leave it for now,” Mydei muttered, his hand resting on Phainon’s cheek. His eyes met Phainon’s, and there was something deeper in that gaze—a flicker of something that wasn’t there before.

Phainon didn’t press, but his eyes softened. He nodded slowly, still keeping the concern in his chest, but now more cautious. The kiss he pressed to Mydei’s palm lingered, as if holding onto the quiet promise that, despite the silence, he was still there.

Mydei felt his chest tighten as Phainon’s gaze softened. It was strange, how something as simple as a touch, a soft kiss to his palm, could make him feel

so… exposed. He was flustered, which irritated him more than it should have. At his age, he should be better at hiding things like that. But there it was—the warmth creeping up his neck as Phainon's concern lingered in the air, and he couldn't push it away.

He didn't care about the scar. It was just a mark. Another reminder of the life he led. But Phainon's touch, so gentle and genuine, made him feel things he'd rather not. The way Phainon didn't press, just quietly nodded, still holding onto that silent promise, made something in Mydei twist in an unfamiliar way.

There was a moment, a fleeting second, where all he could do was watch Phainon. His hair ruffled from their movements, eyes half-lidded, lips parted just slightly. He looked so beautiful in that moment. So… vulnerable. The way he cared, even when Mydei didn't want him to, made something stir in Mydei's chest.

It was ridiculous how it affected him. He shouldn't be getting lost in Phainon's tenderness like this. But his gaze kept drifting back, unable to tear himself away. He admired the way Phainon's body moved, the way his lips made little gasps with each breath. Mydei couldn't help but be drawn in.

And that's when it hit him—the hunger, the undeniable pull. It wasn't just tenderness he craved now. It was Phainon. All of him.

He lowered himself, lips trailing down Phainon's neck, ignoring the tug of emotion in his chest. He didn't have time for that. He didn't have time to care about anything but the feel of Phainon's skin against his, the way his body reacted to every touch, every movement.

Phainon was like a drug—his touch, his care, his presence—it was all too much. Mydei wanted more, needed more, and as his lips brushed against Phainon's shoulder, he could feel himself giving in completely.

No. He didn't care about anything else. He was done pretending he wasn't affected by this. The way Phainon made him feel? The way his concern hit him in a way that made him forget everything?

Yeah, Mydei definitely wasn’t thinking about the scar anymore.

-

Phainon trudged through the door, his shoulders slumped, his mind clouded by a whirlwind of kids’ troubled lives that he couldn’t shake off. Today had been a hell of a day—one of those days when everything seemed to go wrong. The weight of the world, or maybe just his workload, seemed to push him deeper into exhaustion with each step.

He didn’t bother taking his shoes off, didn’t bother anything really. The moment he stepped inside, his legs buckled, and without any pretense, he just collapsed against Mydei, groaning like a man on the brink of death.

“I’m dead,” Phainon muttered, voice muffled against Mydei’s chest. He could barely find the energy to lift his head, so he let it rest there, not caring in the slightest.

Mydei barely flinched, used to the routine. His arm instinctively wrapped around Phainon’s shoulders, holding him steady with that same casual air he always had. It was like he’d learned how to handle this with a nonchalance that bordered on second nature. “You’re tired again?” he muttered, his tone flat as if he was asking about the weather, not his husband’s entire state of exhaustion.

“More like dead inside,” Phainon sighed, but he didn’t move. His face was still buried against Mydei’s chest, his arms loosely draped around him as if Mydei were his personal lifeline. A few minutes like this and he’d probably be able to crawl out of his shell and pretend to be a functional human being again.

But for now, he was just tired.

As he shifted, his hand brushed across something on the coffee table. Half-asleep, his brain barely registering what he was holding, he absentmindedly grabbed it, glancing down with one barely open eye. His fingers curled around the cool object, and at first, it didn’t even click that it was strange.

“What the hell’s this…?” Phainon muttered, his thoughts sluggish from exhaustion.

Only when he finally got a good look at it did it dawn on him: it was a gun. His eyes widened just a fraction, but sleep-deprivation muddled his thoughts. It didn’t seem real.

“Uh… What even is this?” He blinked, squinting at the object in his hand. Still not entirely sure what was going on, he shrugged. “Must be a prop or something.”

Amused by his own absurdity, he lifted it like some sort of poorly thought-out gag, pointing it lazily at his own head.

“Bam,” he said, mimicking the sound of a shot. His lips curled into a tired smirk, half-laughing at the absurdity of the situation, as if he were in some stupid action movie.

But the moment the words left his lips, his body lost its last thread of energy, and he slumped into Mydei’s chest. His arms felt like lead, and he passed out almost instantly, his body going limp against Mydei without another sound.

Mydei’s gaze flicked down to the gun in Phainon’s hand, initially uncaring. He’d seen Phainon grab strange things before, usually not worth thinking twice about. But then, as he processed it for a moment longer, the reality hit him— *Oh shit.*

His stomach dropped. The gun. The real gun. It was definitely loaded.

His breath caught in his chest, and he instinctively reached out. But by the time his hand got halfway there, Phainon had already passed out, collapsing against him like a dead weight.

Mydei blinked, staring at the gun on the coffee table for a beat. Exhaling slowly, his heart suddenly hammered in his chest.

Goddamn it.

It wasn’t even the fact that Phainon had done something careless like this. He was used to the idiot’s forgetfulness and his tendency to absentmindedly grab things. But this? A loaded gun in his hand, pointed right at his own head, even if it was for a joke? Mydei’s stomach twisted.

For a moment, his mind replayed the scene—Phainon’s tired, absentminded smile as he had pointed it at himself, the laugh that followed. What if… *What if he’d pulled the trigger without thinking? What if he’d been too tired to even realize what was in his hand?*

Mydei swallowed hard, his chest tight. He had gotten too comfortable, left the damn thing lying around. Phainon hadn’t seen the danger, and somehow Mydei had let it happen.

His fingers brushed over Phainon’s hair, the sensation of his husband’s head resting against his chest almost too calming. Still, the frantic pulse in Mydei’s chest wouldn’t slow.

He wasn’t going to wake Phainon. The idiot was finally asleep, and Mydei couldn’t let him see how shaken he was by the stupid, reckless moment.

But still…the weight of the gun, the near-miss—it stayed in his mind. The stupid fucking thing.

His heart refused to calm down. He felt ridiculous, but that brief moment of panic hadn’t left him. *What if Phainon had made the wrong move?*

He closed his eyes, trying to shake it off. *It’s over. Nothing happened. It wasn’t even worth thinking about.*

Still, he couldn’t help but grip Phainon’s shoulders tighter, holding him just a little closer, as if reminding himself that he still had him here. Safe.

But damn, he really had to start hiding that gun better.

-

The morning air was crisp, the kind of cold that woke Phainon up better than any cup of coffee ever could. His jog had started off normally enough

—quiet streets, the rhythmic pounding of his feet against the pavement, the occasional wave to a familiar face. Everything was peaceful.

Until a cat stole a child's toy right in front of him.

He had been passing by a small park when he heard the kid's distressed wail. Instinctively, he slowed to a stop, looking over to see a little girl pointing toward a smug-looking cat sitting just out of reach, a bright blue stuffed rabbit clamped in its jaws.

Phainon frowned. "Hey, that's not yours," he muttered as if the cat could understand him.

The cat, unbothered, flicked its tail and bolted.

And that should have been the end of it. He should have just let it go. But the kid had looked so sad, and well… it was just a cat, right? He could totally get the toy back.

So, naturally, he ran after it.

Which led him here—wherever here was.

His jog had turned into a full-on pursuit through the city, the cat zigzagging through alleys and side streets like it was leading him on some kind of demented scavenger hunt. He had nearly lost it a few times, but he had just managed to corner the little bastard when he realized—

Oh.

This was *not* a normal alleyway.

Phainon came to a slow stop, standing at the edge of what looked like… a meeting? A very *serious* meeting. Several men, dressed in suits or leather jackets, stood in a loose circle, tense and alert. One of them was speaking in low, sharp tones to another man who looked like he had just gotten the absolute *shit* beaten out of him. A few others had their hands tucked into their coats in a way that immediately screamed *hidden* weapons.

The cat, completely unbothered, trotted right into the middle of it all.

Phainon, still slightly out of breath, was frozen in place, watching the men slowly turn their heads toward him.

There was a thick silence.

"…Uh." Phainon blinked. "Hi?"

Not a single person moved.

He glanced down at the cat, who had finally dropped the stuffed rabbit at its feet, licking a paw like it hadn't just led him into the world's worst possible situation.

Phainon sighed and crouched down, carefully picking up the slightly damp toy. "Cool. Thanks for that, buddy," he mumbled to the cat before standing up, giving the very obviously dangerous men a quick nod. "Sorry. Didn't mean to interrupt."

Still, no one spoke.

Sweet Kephale, *tough crowd* .

He cleared his throat, shifting awkwardly. "Alright, uh. I'll just… be on my way, then."

He turned, taking a single step back toward the street—

"Hold it."

Phainon froze.

Oh. Well. That wasn't good.

Phainon barely had time to process the command before the sound of shifting footsteps followed. He sighed internally. *Of course* they weren't just going to let him leave.

Slowly, he turned back around, stuffing the slightly damp stuffed rabbit into his hoodie pocket. The men were watching him with unreadable expressions—well, mostly unreadable. Some looked amused. Some looked irritated. One guy, who was definitely *someone important* judging by the way the others stood near him, was staring him down like Phainon had just spat in his drink.

Phainon lifted his hands slightly, a universal *I come in peace* gesture. “Look, I really was just chasing a cat. No clue what you guys have going on here—don’t wanna know. I’ll be on my way.”

The man in charge— probably in charge, if Phainon had to guess—tilted his head slightly, his gaze cold and calculating. “You’re not from around here.”

Phainon blinked. “I literally live like fifteen minutes away.”

A low chuckle came from one of the guys on the side. Phainon wasn’t sure if that was a *good* sign or a *bad* one. The air was still tense, thick with something unspoken.

“Bad luck,” another guy muttered, shaking his head. “Real bad luck.”

Phainon sighed. “Yeah, yeah. I get it. Wrong place, wrong time. *Extremely* wrong place, wrong time.” He rocked on his heels, trying to gauge just how *screwed* he was right now. “But, in my defense, if you saw a cat steal a kid’s toy, wouldn’t you try to get it back?”

Silence.

One of the men—tall, muscular, definitely armed—shifted slightly, lips twitching. “No.”

“Wow. Harsh.”

Another guy, younger-looking, actually snorted. The one in charge—let’s call him *Mr. Intimidating* —wasn’t laughing. His sharp gaze flicked over Phainon, his expression unreadable.

“You seem awfully calm.”

Phainon shrugged. “I mean, what’s panicking gonna do? Besides, you guys don’t *seem* like you’re gonna kill me.” He gave them a once-over, squinting. “Right?”

No one answered.

Okay. *Not* the best reassurance.

Before anyone could say anything else, there was a new sound—the distinct click of expensive shoes against pavement. Phainon barely had time to process it before a familiar voice, smooth and *unbothered* , cut through the air like a blade.

“Am I interrupting something?”

Phainon’s shoulders immediately relaxed, turning to see—

“Mydei!” He let out an exaggerated sigh of relief, grinning as his husband approached. “Oh, thank *God* —can you tell these guys I’m not some rival spy or whatever?”

Mydei’s expression didn’t change. His gaze flickered over Phainon, then to the group of men, his posture languid but *dangerously* casual.

Mr. Intimidating took a step back, clearly recognizing him. “This is *yours* ?”

Phainon frowned. “Rude. I’m my own person, thank you—”

Mydei cut him off with a sharp, almost lazy smile, though there was no humor in his eyes. “He’s mine.”

There was a beat of silence. Phainon could feel the shift in tension, but before he could dwell on it, Mydei’s hand slid around his wrist, tugging him forward in a way that made it very clear he wasn’t giving him a choice.

“Come on, darling,” Mydei murmured, his grip firm. “Let’s get you home.”

Phainon blinked, glancing back at the group. They were still watching him, their expressions a mix of confusion, disbelief, and in some cases, barely restrained amusement .

He shot them a sheepish wave. “Uh. Nice meeting you all?”

No response.

Yikes.

Phainon let Mydei pull him away, and as they rounded a corner, out of sight, he exhaled. “So, uh. Funny story—”

“Not funny,” Mydei said flatly.

Phainon huffed. “*Kind* of funny.”

Mydei gave him a sharp look, then exhaled through his nose, pinching the bridge of it like he was actively suppressing the urge to kill someone. Probably him.

“…How,” Mydei finally asked, voice dripping with *exhaustion*, “did you *actually* manage to walk into the middle of *that*?”

Phainon hesitated.

Then, with complete honesty, he answered:

“Cat.”

Mydei just stared at him.

And for once, he had nothing to say.

Mydei didn’t say a word as he dragged Phainon down the street, his grip firm but not enough to hurt. He could feel his own pulse thrumming under his skin, his expression carefully neutral, but inside? Inside, he was seething.

Of all the reckless, *stupid* things Phainon could've done— *walking straight into a mafia meeting* because of a goddamn cat?

No. He wasn't going to think about what could've happened. He wasn't going to let himself dwell on the image of Phainon standing there, surrounded by armed men, completely oblivious to the fact that he had been inches away from getting himself killed.

The worst part?

Phainon still didn't get it.

"Are you mad?" Phainon asked, peering up at him with wide, innocent eyes. As if he hadn't just walked into a *very real, very dangerous* situation without a single ounce of self-preservation.

Mydei exhaled through his nose, forcing his voice to stay even. "No."

Phainon squinted at him. "You look mad."

"I'm not mad."

"Okay, but you're holding my wrist like you're deciding whether or not to throw me into oncoming traffic."

Mydei released his wrist immediately. He wasn't going to dignify that with a response.

Phainon rolled his shoulders, letting out a sigh. "Look, I get that those guys were *probably* bad news, but I didn't know! I just—"

"You pointed at the leader's face and asked if he was 'in charge of the secret club.'"

Phainon blinked. "…Did I?"

Mydei closed his eyes briefly. He needed a moment.

Phainon had no idea how lucky he was. If Mydei hadn’t walked in at the right moment, if it had been anyone else stumbling in, if someone had been *trigger-happy* or even just slightly annoyed—

God.

The thought made something in Mydei’s chest coil so tightly it nearly hurt.

They walked in silence for a few more blocks. Mydei was still too aware of the phantom tension in his muscles, the leftover adrenaline making his fingers twitch.

Then—

“Hey,” Phainon said, bumping their shoulders together lightly. “I’m okay.”

Mydei stopped walking.

Phainon turned to him, his expression softer now, the teasing gone. Of course he noticed.

“I really am,” Phainon continued, offering a small, tired smile. “And I know you’re probably running through all the ways I could’ve been murdered, but —”

Mydei kissed him.

It wasn’t slow, and it wasn’t gentle. It was frustration and relief and you’re so goddamn lucky I found you first all pressed into one.

When he pulled back, Phainon blinked up at him, slightly dazed. Then, he exhaled a breathy little laugh. “I *knew* you were mad.”

Mydei sighed, pressing their foreheads together. “I’m going to strangle you.”

Phainon hummed. “Romantic.”

Mydei exhaled sharply, but this time, his grip on Phainon's wrist was lighter, looser, a silent reassurance that he was still there. Still in one piece.

Even if he was the biggest fucking idiot alive.

Mydei was going to have to kill that damn cat.

Phainon huffed, arms crossed, standing with his foot tapping as he glanced at Mydei. The man was practically refusing to go to the hospital, claiming the injury was from tripping down the stairs. Phainon wasn't buying it. Mydei, who was always too proud and too stubborn for his own good, had been bleeding for far too long, and Phainon was done with the excuses.

"Come on, Mydei, this is ridiculous," Phainon muttered, his voice strained as he tried to drag Mydei along. "We're going to the damn hospital, whether you like it or not."

Mydei winced as Phainon yanked him by the arm, muttering something about "needing to rest" and "it's not that bad," but Phainon was over it. He could throw him over his shoulder if he had to.

Before he could, though, they reached a street corner. The faint sounds of yelling caught his attention, and he instinctively pulled Mydei to the side as a glass storefront shattered in front of them. The screams of a scuffle echoed, and Phainon instinctively stepped in front of Mydei, shielding him.

The movement happened so fast—before Phainon could register fully what was going on, something sharp slammed into his side. A sudden pain, hot and searing, made him gasp, and he stumbled back a step. The crackling of broken glass rang in his ears as he fought to stay steady on his feet.

"What the hell?" Phainon said under his breath in pain.

One of the men from the scuffle, clearly not too concerned about a civilian like Phainon, stormed toward him. Before he could even think to react, a hand grabbed him from behind, pulling him roughly around.

A cold metal pressed into his temple.

“Stay the fuck still, dumbass,” a voice growled harshly in his ear, sending a jolt of panic through Phainon’s chest.

Phainon immediately assessed the situation, keeping his breathing steady despite the adrenaline coursing through him. The gun was pressed against his skull, the hand behind him tight and unrelenting, but there was something oddly familiar about the man’s stance.

This wasn’t just some random thug.

“Shit,” Phainon muttered under his breath, eyes darting around. “This is not how I wanted to go out today.”

He prepared for the worst, thinking about how he’d probably never get a chance to write a will for Mydei, or worse, never get to tell him the truth about how much he fucking adored him.

But just as he was about to make his peace, the guy holding him stiffened. His breath faltered, and Phainon felt the change in his posture—a mix of confusion, disbelief, and fear.

Phainon’s mind clicked as he glanced at Mydei, who had remained unnervingly calm throughout the entire ordeal, but now, as Phainon’s eyes met the man’s, a strange shift happened. The thug’s eyes darted over to Mydei, and the blood drained from his face. Phainon watched, almost in slow motion, as the thug’s stance wavered, his grip loosening on Phainon’s arm.

“B-boss?” the guy stuttered, his voice trembling as he looked back at Mydei.

Phainon blinked, confused. What the hell was going on?

The man quickly started to backpedal, stammering words that didn’t make sense. “I didn’t mean to… I—please, I wasn’t gonna—”

The gun, which had been firmly pressed to his head just moments ago, was now trembling in the guy's hand as he slowly lowered it.

Phainon, still in a daze, had an odd moment of clarity.

"Boss? What do you-oh," he murmured absentmindedly, realization finally setting in. "Well, that's not good for you."

But before he could process the situation further, his head started spinning. The blood loss from his own injury combined with the shock of the entire situation overwhelmed him. His vision blurred, and his legs went weak.

The last thing he remembered was the sensation of falling forward, his head hitting Mydei's chest before everything went black.

Phainon's blood was smeared on Mydei's chest, and the weight of it hit him harder than any blow. His mind blanked for a split second, the rush of panic and worry taking over, but the clarity that followed was terrifying in its own way. It wasn't just fear; it was a sense of helplessness that Mydei had never allowed himself to feel, not for anyone—not even himself.

The coldness in his chest was immediate. His heart was hammering in his chest, but it wasn't from the adrenaline. It was from the sheer intensity of everything crashing down on him. Phainon, the idiot who'd somehow weaseled his way into his world, now bleeding out in his arms—and Mydei had to stop for a moment, just to take it all in.

He wasn't going to let Phainon die in his arms. Not like this.

His eyes darted from the bloodied man in his arms to the scum still standing nearby, but he couldn't care less about him right now. Not until Phainon was safe. Mydei kept his grip tight on Phainon, his arms locked around him with a fierce protectiveness that bordered on desperate. The rage was there, bubbling just under the surface, but it was controlled, tightly wound.

"Mydei…" Phainon murmured weakly, but Mydei didn't answer, focusing entirely on the task at hand. He couldn't afford to break, not now.

The man who'd done this stood there, frozen, eyes wide as he watched the scene unfold. Mydei's gaze flicked to him, but there was no hesitation. The guy didn't matter. The world around him didn't matter. Phainon did. He needed to get Phainon to the hospital, fast.

But when the guy made the mistake of looking at him, Mydei's gaze turned stone cold, his voice low and dangerous. "You're lucky I have other things to worry about right now, you fucking idiot." His voice was chilling, and it was laced with the kind of rage that made the man flinch. Mydei wasn't done, though. "But once I'm done with him, I swear to God, you won't make it out of this city alive. I'll drag you through every last corner of hell."

He turned away without another word, keeping Phainon close as they moved out of the alley and onto the sidewalk. But every word had been a promise, every word a reminder that this wouldn't be forgotten. Once Phainon was safe, once he had time to breathe, Mydei was going to make that man suffer in ways he couldn't even imagine.

But for now, all that mattered was Phainon.

Mydei's heart didn't slow down, even as he sprinted through the streets. Every breath felt tight, each step a pounding reminder of what was at stake. He didn't even look around—didn't care if he knocked into people or if a car honked at him. Nothing mattered except getting Phainon to that hospital.

His chest burned from the effort, but Mydei wasn't slowing down. He couldn't. Not when Phainon was this close to slipping away. He had no idea how much blood Phainon had lost or what damage had been done, but it didn't matter. He could feel Phainon's weight in his arms, but he kept him pressed close, determined not to let him go.

It felt like forever, but when they finally burst through the hospital doors, the staff immediately sprang into action. Mydei barely noticed. He didn't care about the doctors or the nurses or the chaos that came with an emergency room. He was too focused on the limp body in his arms, his heart still hammering.

The last thing he remembered before they whisked Phainon away was the soft, almost inaudible “I’m here, I’m here,” that had slipped from his lips. Mydei stood there, staring at the door they took him through, fists clenched as he fought to keep himself steady.

When Phainon finally came to, the first thing he noticed was the sterile smell. The soft beeping. The steady pressure of Mydei’s hand on his, even though Phainon could barely open his eyes.

“Hey…” Phainon mumbled, his voice rough, but there was an odd warmth in his chest. He could feel Mydei’s presence, strong and unyielding, hovering over him. “You good?”

Mydei’s voice was low, a steady, calming rumble that made Phainon want to smile. “Yeah. I’m good.” There was a slight pause before Mydei added, “You had me worried, idiot.”

Phainon blinked slowly, still disoriented, but his lips curved into a weak grin. “I’m fine… mostly.”

The room was quiet for a moment, the tension from earlier hanging in the air, but Phainon could sense the subtle shift. Mydei’s hand, still gripping his, softened, and there was something in the way he looked at Phainon that made it clear—things were different now.

Phainon cleared his throat, his voice light despite the weakness in it. “So… the guy who did this…” he started, but the words hung in the air between them. His lips twitched as he took in Mydei’s tense, rigid posture. “You gonna tell me about him now?”

Mydei’s jaw clenched. Phainon could see it in his eyes—the hesitation, the tension that had been carefully masked until now. But Phainon had already pieced it together, from the blood, the blood on Mydei, the way he’d handled everything with a cold, calculated precision.

The pieces clicked.

“Phainon, I—” Mydei began, but Phainon just held up a hand, cutting him off.

“I know,” Phainon said quietly, a small, teasing smile spreading on his face. “I know what you do.”

For a long moment, Mydei didn’t speak, his eyes locked onto Phainon’s with an unreadable expression.

“I’m not mad,” Phainon added, his voice soft. “You know that, right?”

Mydei didn’t say anything at first, just looked at him for a moment longer, the silence stretching between them. And then, with a subtle exhale, he finally spoke, his tone almost joking, but with a hint of relief.

“So… Can I join?” Phainon asked casually, his eyebrows raising just enough to show he wasn’t taking things too seriously.

Mydei blinked, his lips twitching as if he was going to say something, but then he let out a quiet chuckle. It was the first time in what felt like forever that Mydei’s posture softened, and for the briefest moment, they were just two people, sitting in a hospital room—one still recovering, the other more than a little amused at his ridiculousness.

Phainon laughed weakly, his grin widening. “Just kidding. But, seriously, you know… I’d make a great asset. You’re not getting rid of me that easy.”

Mydei’s eyes flickered with a strange mix of amusement and exasperation. “No, you’re not,” he muttered, but his voice was lighter, almost fond.

Phainon’s smile didn’t fade, even as the weight of everything else still hung over them. Mydei didn’t respond, but Phainon could tell—he was going to be okay.

And maybe, just maybe, so was Mydei.

End Notes

Hmmm tell me your thoughts on alt au Phaidei/Myphai fanfics and if u guys want more of that or canon compliance/divergence. Either works for me but I'll do whichever u guys want more of.

Rn I'm stuck on my False deliverer fic, I have an outline FINALLY ready but I'm conflicted on chapter 5, the last one on whether they should have seggs there and if they do who should top, so here's my tribute till I finally get to writing the 4th chapter😭

Sorry for the shit ending y'all, I was shivering in my timbers cause I got scared I'll get caught (Yes I'm pathetic don't remind me)

Thank you for reading <3333

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!